

Economics Week Ahead

Weekly

United States:

- [Retail Sales](#) (Tuesday), [Kevin Warsh Confirmation Hearing](#) (Tuesday)

G10 Economies:

- [Canada CPI](#) (Monday), [U.K. Labor Market & CPI](#) (Tuesday & Wednesday)

Wells Fargo Economics Week Ahead					
United States					
Indicator Releases		Period	Consensus	Wells Fargo	Prior
21-Apr	Retail Sales (MoM)	Mar	1.3%	2.0%	0.6%
21-Apr	Retail Sales Ex Auto (MoM)	Mar	1.3%	1.7%	0.5%
Fed Speakers (*Designating 2026 Voting Member)					
Fed's External Communications Blackout Period (04/18 - 04/30)					
International					
G10 Economies		Period	Consensus	Wells Fargo	Prior
20-Apr	Canada CPI (MoM)	Mar	1.1%	0.9%	0.5%
20-Apr	Canada CPI (YoY)	Mar	2.6%	2.4%	1.8%
20-Apr	Canada CPI Core Median (YoY)	Mar	2.4%	2.4%	2.3%
20-Apr	Canada CPI Core Trimmed (YoY)	Mar	2.3%	2.4%	2.3%
21-Apr	U.K. ILO Unemployment Rate (3M)	Mar	5.2%	5.2%	5.2%
21-Apr	U.K. Average Weekly Earnings	Mar	3.6%	—	3.9%
22-Apr	U.K. CPI (MoM)	Mar	0.6%	0.6%	0.4%
22-Apr	U.K. CPI (YoY)	Mar	3.3%	3.3%	3.0%
22-Apr	U.K. Core CPI (YoY)	Mar	3.2%	3.2%	3.2%

Forecast as of April 17, 2026
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and Wells Fargo Economics

Related Information:

- [U.S. Economic Forecast](#)
- [FOMC 101](#)
- [U.S. Tariff Tracker](#)
- [U.S. Tariff Policy 101](#)
- [2026 Economic Calendar](#)

U.S. Week Ahead

Retail Sales • Tuesday

Consumers have largely been unfazed by the initial move higher in prices at the pump. High-frequency credit card data from Bloomberg suggests households have continued to spend into early April ([chart](#)), and we forecast broader retail sales popped 2.0% in March.

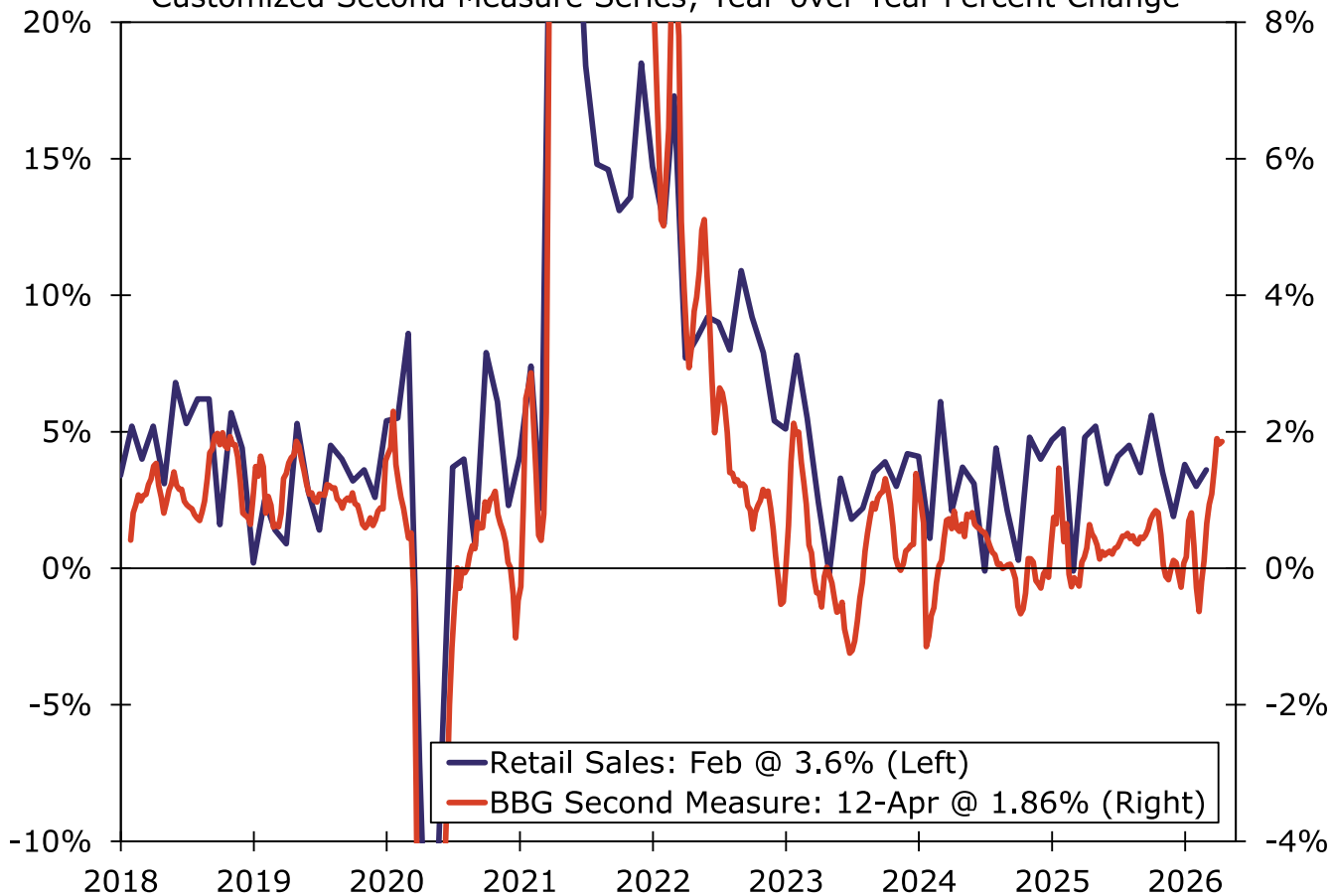
That gain, however, partially reflects higher prices rather than increased sales volume given retail sales are reported nominally. Overall sales were likely still broad in March, but we expect an outsized gain will stem from gasoline sales specifically reflecting higher prices. Consumer goods prices jumped 2% in March from a month earlier. In stripping out the price effects, sales were weaker last month than the headline data will suggest.

We expect continued but slower spending in the wake of the ongoing conflict in Iran as higher tax refunds and after-tax incomes are largely offsetting the initial hit from higher gas prices. The longer this goes on, and the broader inflationary pressure becomes, the more concerned we grow on consumer resilience.

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U.S. Retail Sales Growth

Monthly Census Bureau vs. 28-Day Trailing Weekly Bloomberg
Customized Second Measure Series; Year-over-Year Percent Change



Source: U.S. Department of Commerce, Bloomberg Finance L.P. and Wells Fargo Economics

Kevin Warsh Confirmation Hearing • Tuesday

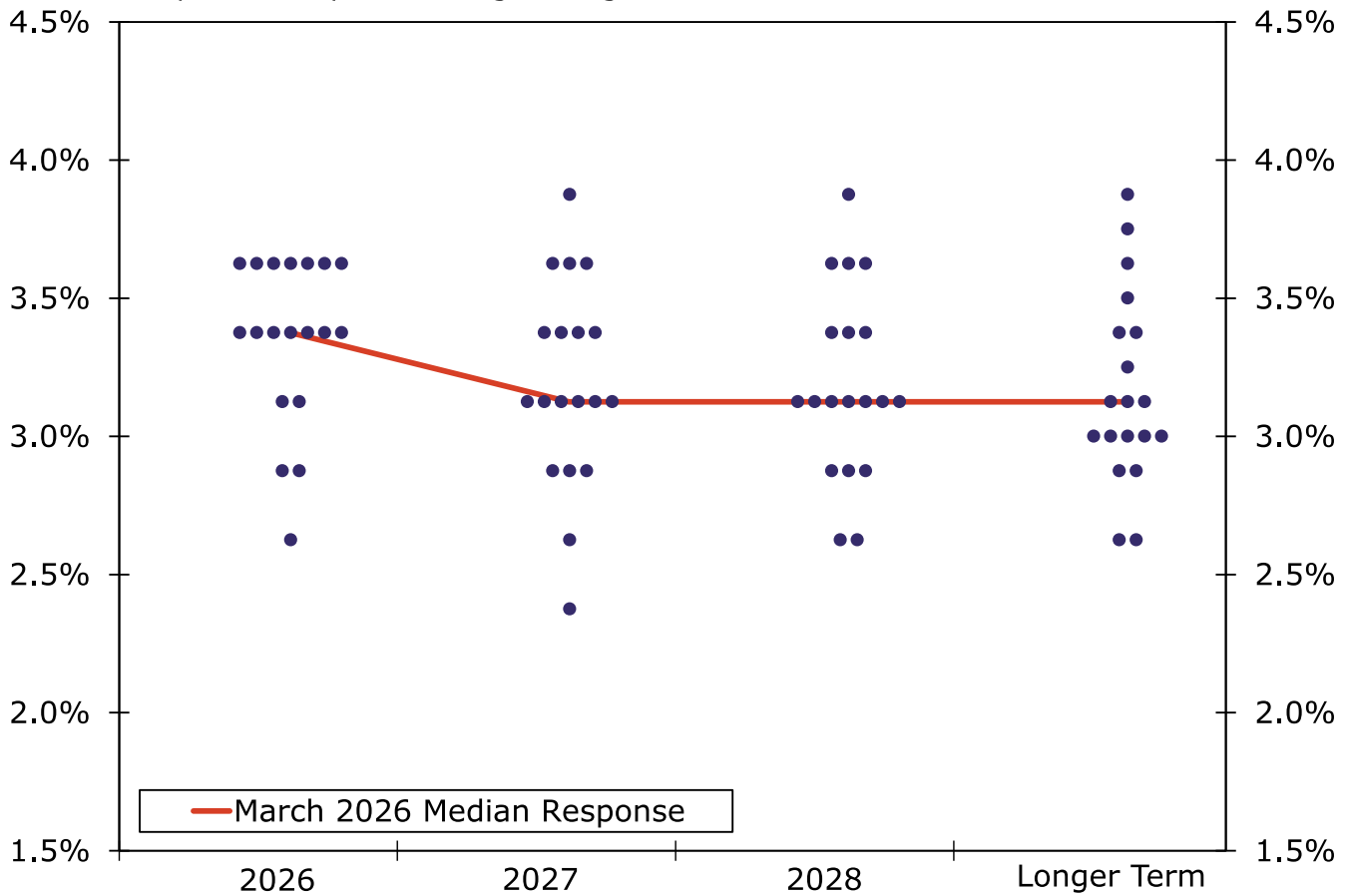
The Senate Banking Committee is scheduled to hold a confirmation hearing for Kevin Warsh on April 21. Warsh's nomination to be the next Chair of the Federal Reserve has been in limbo since [President Trump chose Kevin Warsh](#) for the position on January 29. Completing his confirmation hearing is an important step toward eventually becoming Fed Chair, but a major hurdle still looms, with Senator Thom Tillis (R-NC) still promising to block Warsh's nomination until the criminal probe by the Department of Justice into the Fed is lifted. Powell's term as Chair ends in May, but if Warsh is not confirmed by then, Powell will continue to serve as Chair pro tempore until his replacement has been confirmed.

Warsh's confirmation hearing will be a helpful update on his views on the monetary policy outlook and the Federal Reserve more generally. Warsh's last public comments on monetary policy came way back in November in a [Wall Street Journal opinion piece](#). We are particularly interested in Warsh's near-term views on the appropriateness of the current level of the fed funds rate, the longer run neutral rate and Fed policy implementation questions, such as its communication tools and balance sheet.

We suspect Warsh will play it safe and try to be as vague as possible in most of his answers, a strategy designed to avoid alienating Senate support as well as members of the FOMC. But, he will not be able to duck all the questions, and given his lack of recent public comments and the wide range of views across the Committee at present, any tips or clues on core views will be extremely helpful for understanding the outlook.

March 2026 FOMC Dot Plot

Expected Midpoint of Target Range for the Federal Funds Rate at Year-End



Source: Federal Reserve Board and Wells Fargo Economics

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G10 Week Ahead

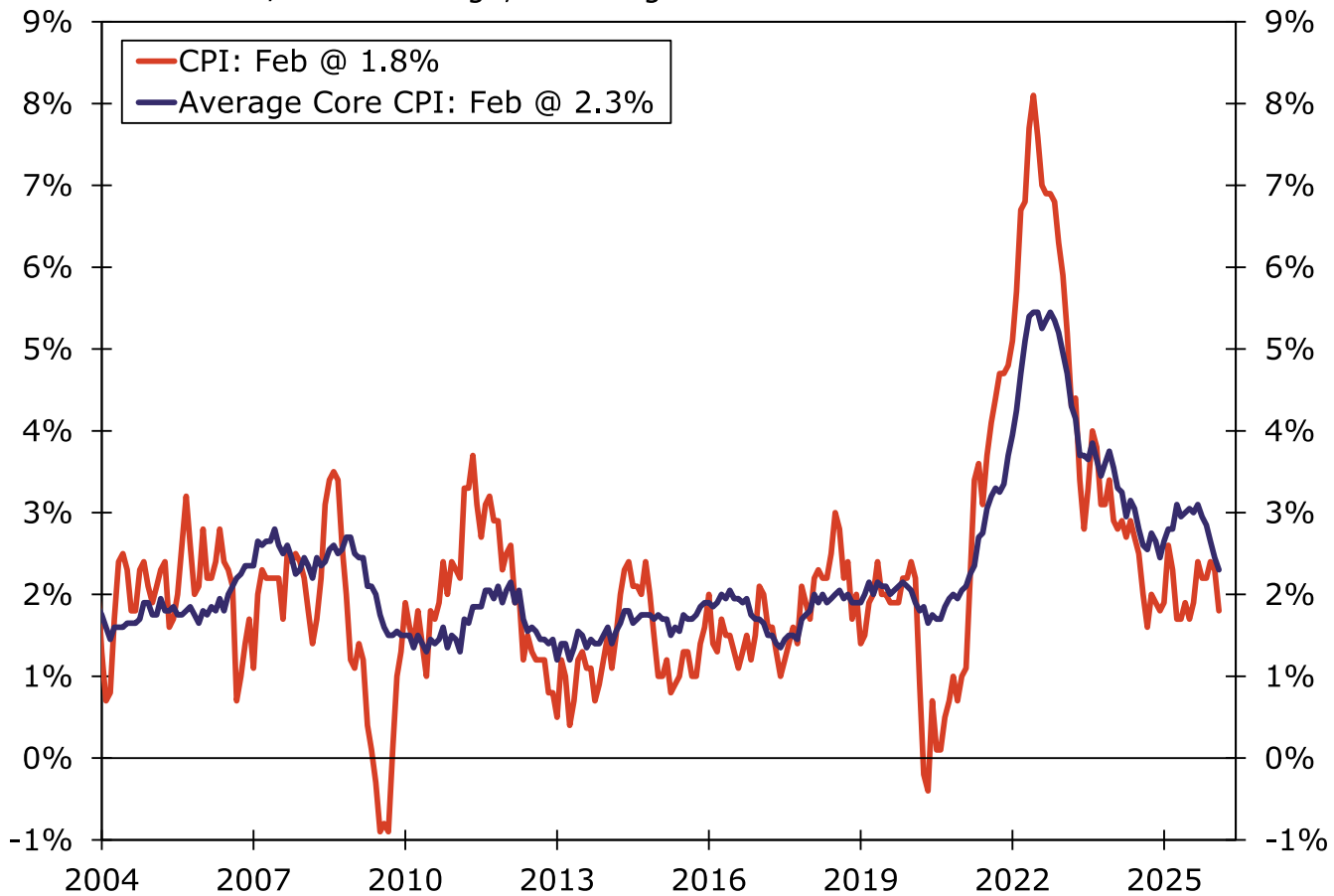
Canada CPI • Monday

We expect March headline CPI to print 0.9% month-over-month implying 2.4% year-over-year, which would be a significant acceleration from 1.8% in February. The February print was deceptively soft on account of the GST/HST holiday, and the March reading will be the last to carry those effects. At the same time, the energy supply shock as a result of the US-Iran conflict will add substantially to the March reading with additional carryover for April. In fact, our early estimate for April inflation is for the year-over-year print to be close or above 3%. On the core measures, we expect a slower move higher with both the year-over-year median and trimmed CPI at 2.4%. We continue to believe the overall effect of higher energy prices is a small positive for growth and more of an inflationary concern for the Bank of Canada (BoC). As such, the BoC's calculus has likely shifted from a hold-cut decision to hold-hike in upcoming meetings. A +3% inflation reading is a breach of the upper bound of the BoC's target range and implies negative real rates in Canada at least through end-2026 if current policy is maintained. An April 29 hold looks certain to us with the BoC likely to lean heavily on optionality given uncertainty in the Middle East and the USMCA renegotiation. With a clean reading on the effect of higher energy prices more likely starting in the April reading, June is the earliest possible timing for a BoC hike. We think that the BoC may opt to delay a hike decision till July, especially with the looming USMCA renegotiation deadline for July 1 and a broader presentation of its outlook in the July Monetary Policy Report.

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Canadian Inflation

Yr/Yr Pct. Change, Core Avg. of Trim & Median Measures



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and Wells Fargo Economics

U.K. Labor Market & CPI • Tuesday & Wednesday

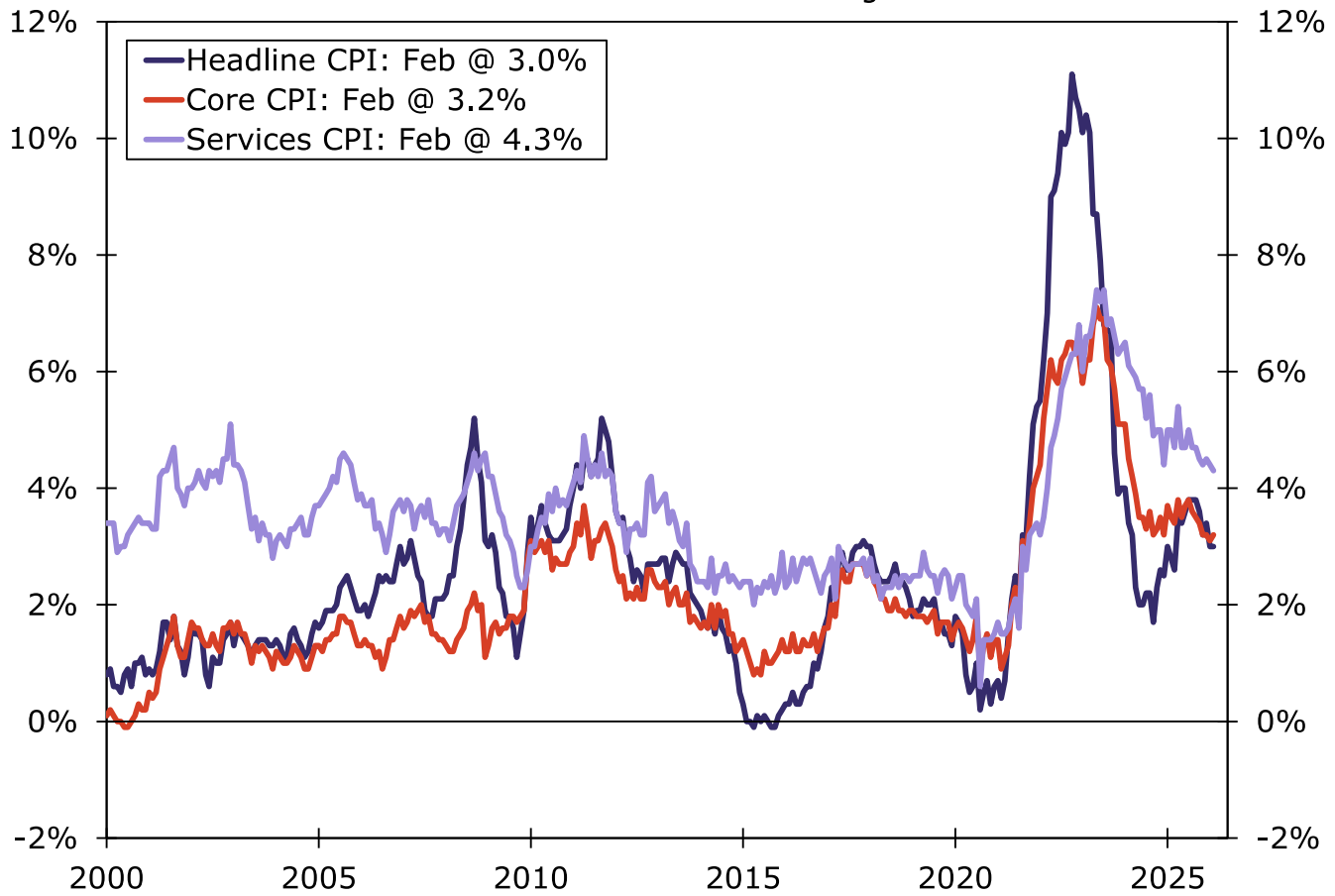
Next week will be busy for U.K. data releases, which market participants will closely scrutinize as they assess the economic impact of the conflict in the Middle East and its implications for Bank of England (BoE) policy.

The key release will be the March CPI report. We expect headline inflation to rise to 3.3% year-over-year from 3.0%, driven by the energy supply shock, while core inflation is expected to hold at 3.2%, matching February and in line with consensus expectations. This would mark a significant reversal in the progress toward disinflation seen in the U.K. through February and is likely to persist for several months.

CPI will not be the only release next week. We expect further moderation in wage growth over the three months through February, an unchanged unemployment rate at 5.2% in March and a subdued March retail sales reading, likely reflecting higher fuel prices. Taken together, these data should reinforce the case, in our view, for continued BoE caution and data dependence. While a higher headline inflation print may be viewed as a tightening signal, as long as wage pressures remain contained amid weak growth and elevated unemployment, we expect the BoE to remain on hold at 3.75% this year. Risks are skewed to the upside, particularly if underlying dynamics shift and second-round effects become more prominent.

U.K. Consumer Prices

Year-over-Year Percent Change



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and Wells Fargo Economics

([Return](#))

Economist(s)



[Tom Porcelli](#)



[Tim Quinlan](#)



[Sarah House](#)



[Aroop Chatterjee](#)



[Charlie Dougherty](#)



[Michael Pugliese](#)



[Jackie Benson](#)



[Shannon Grein](#)



[Nicole Cervi](#)

Economics Group

Tom Porcelli	Chief Economist	212-214-6422	Tom.Porcelli@wellsfargo.com
Tim Quinlan	Senior Economist	704-410-3283	Tim.Quinlan@wellsfargo.com
Sarah House	Senior Economist	704-410-3282	Sarah.House@wellsfargo.com
Aroop Chatterjee	Senior Economist	212-214-8819	Aroop.Chatterjee@wellsfargo.com
Charlie Dougherty	Senior Economist	212-214-8984	Charles.Dougherty@wellsfargo.com
Michael Pugliese	Senior Economist	212-214-5058	Michael.D.Pugliese@wellsfargo.com
Jackie Benson	Economist	704-410-4468	Jackie.Benson@wellsfargo.com
Shannon Grein	Economist	704-410-0369	Shannon.Grein@wellsfargo.com
Nicole Cervi	Economist	704-410-3059	Nicole.Cervi@wellsfargo.com
Delaney Conner	Economic Analyst	704-374-2150	Delaney.Conner@wellsfargo.com
Ali Hajibeigi	Economic Analyst	212-214-8253	Ali.Hajibeigi@wellsfargo.com
Azhin Abdulkarim	Economic Analyst	212-214-5154	Azhin.Abdulkarim@wellsfargo.com
Anagha Sridharan	Economic Analyst	704-410-6212	Anagha.Sridharan@wellsfargo.com
Andrew Thompson	Economic Analyst	704-410-2911	Andrew.L.Thompson@wellsfargo.com

All estimates/forecasts are as of 4/17/2026 unless otherwise stated. 4/17/2026 12:27:31 EDT.

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